

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

How do you feel about doing household chores?



Learning Outcome

Describe ways of solving problems and getting things done in social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- How has the division of housework changed in your country in the past 25 years?
- What things, if any, do you not mind doing around the house? Why?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about domestic activities.
- I can explain how to do things.
- I can talk about solving problems.

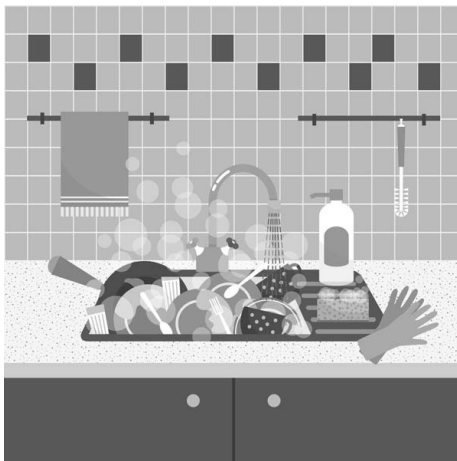




Let's Explore!

Sally suggests having a **house meeting***!

* In a "house meeting" housemates get together to decide on things for the group and house as a whole.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Dear Sally,

I've been reading your blogs for a long time and find them entertaining and insightful. I was wondering if you could help me. I live with three other people who are not very tidy. They don't clean up after themselves like they are supposed to. This isn't acceptable, is it? I prefer things to be orderly and tidy. Can you please give me some advice on how to cope with this problem?

Thanks,

Maria

Dear Maria,

Thank you for being such an avid blog follower and writing to me. It looks like you have a lot on your plate cleaning up after three other people. First, I want to make something clear. You were not supposed to take on all the chores. You are not responsible for cleaning up after your housemates. They said they were going to deal with their own mess. They need to be reminded of that as soon as possible. I would suggest holding a house meeting where you discuss chore responsibilities as a group. Explain that you are not going to clean up after them, that the house cannot always be a mess.

You should decide together what each person is supposed to do during the week. This sort of thing was supposed to happen when you first moved in together, but if it were going to happen now it could still work. If they do not want to clean, suggest they chip in for a cleaning service. I think this is going to be good place to start. Let me know what happens.

Regards,

Sally



Let's Practice!

What are some things that Maria should and shouldn't do?

Instructions: Read the sentences. Classify the sentences into the correct category.

Box #1: Do's Box #2: Dont's

1. You were not supposed to take on all the chores.
2. The house cannot be in a mess.
3. You are not supposed to be cleaning up after your housemates.
4. Suggest they chip in for a cleaning service.
5. You should decide together what each person is supposed to do during the week.
6. Suggest holding a house meeting where you discuss chore responsibilities as a group.

Do's

Dont's



Let's Practice!

Maria's got problems with her roommates ...

Instructions: Draw a line to match the sentences in Column A and Column B. When you complete the sentences, read the sentences aloud with your partner. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

COLUMN A

COLUMN B

- | | |
|---|--------------------------------------|
| 1. They don't clean up after themselves like | a. clean up together. |
| 2. They said they were going to | b. when you first moved in together. |
| 3. This sort of thing was supposed to happen | c. a good place to start. |
| 4. You should decide together what each person is supposed to | d. deal with it. |
| 5. I think this is going to be | e. to move in together. |
| | f. deal with their own mess. |
| | g. do during the week. |
| | h. they said they were going to. |



Extension Activity

Find out how much exercise you get when you do housework.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Go to the library or online to read articles about housework, exercise and calorie burning.
- Take notes as you read at least two articles (in English).
- Write a summary for each of the articles.
- Read your summaries to a partner.
- Discuss the ideas from the article.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I read about domestic activities and exercise.

☐ ☐

I write up summaries of two articles.

☐ ☐

I explain how to burn calories or get exercise while doing housework.

☐ ☐

I share my findings with a partner and discuss them.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- to have a lot on your plate** (expression): to have too many responsibilities at one time
e.g. It looks like you have a lot on your plate cleaning up after three other people.
- acceptable** (adjective): capable or worthy of being accepted
e.g. This isn't acceptable, is it?
- entertaining** (adjective): amusing
e.g. I've been reading your blogs for a long time and find them entertaining and insightful.
- insightful** (adjective): having or showing a deep understanding or perspective
e.g. I've been reading your blogs for a long time and find them entertaining and insightful.
- avid** (adjective): showing great interest in
e.g. Thank you for being such an avid blog follower and writing to me.
- to deal with** (verb): to take action on
e.g. They said they were going to deal with their own mess.
- to chip in** (verb): to contribute money
e.g. They chip in for a cleaning service.





Learning Points

Explaining How Things Were Done

You use *be supposed to* and *was going to* to explain how things were done.

You use the structure **be supposed to** when you want to talk about expectations, obligations or arrangements. You can use this structure using the Past tense to talk about things that you were obligated to do, but didn't or couldn't do.

The structure is:

Subject + to be + *supposed to* + verb

This sort of thing was supposed to happen when you first moved in together.

****Pronunciation tip**:**

When you say *be supposed to*, you link the /d/ and /t/ sounds together.

Like this: Be suppose_to

You use the structure **was going to** when you want to talk about things that you had planned or intended to do.

The structure is:

was/were + *going to* + verb

They said they were going to deal with their own mess.

Examples:

- *This sort of thing was supposed to happen when you first moved in together.*
- *You were not supposed to take on all the chores.*
- *They said they were going to deal with their own mess.*





Learning Points

The Position of **Not**

When you want to emphasize that something or an action is opposite to what is expected, use *not*, rather than a contraction in the sentence.

For example:

*I live with three other people who are **not** very tidy.*

*You were **not** supposed to take on all the chores.*

The **not** shows a firmness on the part of the speaker while still being polite.

When speaking, the **not** is pronounced louder and longer than it is normally.

Examples:

- *Explain that you are not going to clean up after them, and that the house cannot always be a mess.*
- *If they do not want to clean, suggest they chip in for a cleaning service.*
- *You were not supposed to take on all the chores.*

